

0.0.1 Six-factored Giving

1. At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Savatthi in Jeta's Grove, Anathapindika's Park. Now on that occasion the female lay disciple, Nandamata of Velukantaka, was bestowing an offering endowed with six factors to the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana.

2. With the divine eye which is purified and surpasses the human, the Auspicious One saw that the female lay disciple, Nandamata of Velukantaka was bestowing an offering endowed with six factors to the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana. Having seen, he addressed the bhikkhus:

3. This female lay disciple, Nandamata of Velukantaka, O bhikkhus, is bestowing an offering endowed with six factors to the community of bhikkhus headed by Sariputta and Moggallana.

4. And how, O bhikkhus, is the offering endowed with six factors?

5. Here, O bhikkhus, the giver possesses three factors, the recipient possesses three factors.

6. What are the giver's three factors?

7. Here, O bhikkhus, the giver is happy before the offering, offers with a gladdened mind, is elated in mind after the offering. These are the giver's three factors.

8. What are the recipient's three factors?

9. Here, O bhikkhus, the recipients are free from lust or have entered upon the path for the removal of lust. They are free from hatred or have entered upon the path for the removal of hatred. They are free from delusion or have entered upon the path for the removal of delusion. These are the recipient's three factors.

10. So the giver possesses three factors, the recipient possesses three factors. Thus, O bhikkhus, the offering is endowed with six factors.

11. O bhikkhus, for an offering thus endowed with six factors, it is not easy to calculate the measure of merits so as to say: "This much stream of merit, this much stream of the wholesome, nutriment of happiness, connected with heaven, ripening in pleasure, leading to heaven, leading to what is wished for, to what is agreeable, to what is pleasing, to welfare, to happiness." It is simply reckoned as an immeasurable, great mass of merit.

12. Just as, O bhikkhus, it is not easy to calculate the measure of water in the great ocean so as to say, "this

much buckets of water”, or “this much hundreds of buckets of water” or “this much thousands of buckets of water.” It is simply reckoned as an incalculable, immeasurable, great mass of water.

13. So too, O bhikkhus, for an offering thus endowed with six factors, it is not easy to calculate the amount of merits to say, “this much stream of merit, this much stream of the wholesome, nutriment of happiness, connected with heaven, ripening in pleasure, leading to heaven, leading to what is wished for, to what is agreeable, to what is pleasing, to welfare, to happiness.” It is simply reckoned as an immeasurable, great mass of merit.

“Happy before giving,
with a gladdened mind while giving; 14
elated in mind having given,
this is the most excellent of sacrifices.

Free from lust, free from hatred,
free from delusion, free from the asavas; 15
the self-controlled ones faring the life of purity,

are the excellent field for a sacrifice.

Having washed one’s hands and rinsed one’s
mouth,

having given with one's own hands; 16
such a sacrifice is of great fruits,
both for oneself and others.

The wise one having thus sacrificed,
his mind liberated by faith; 17
that wise one arises,
in an unafflictive pleasant world.”